

Mikio Nakamaru

Microsoft security specialist

I work in an MSSP, running Sentinel, Defender XDR, Defender for Cloud, Purview and Entra ID for several clients at once. I write KQL to hunt threats, and PowerShell and Logic Apps to take repetitive work off the analyst's plate.

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São José do Rio Preto, Brazil

- **In IT since 2009**
- **13 active Microsoft certifications**
- **Microsoft Certified Trainer since 2021**
- **Spoke at MVP Conf and TDC in 2026**

Summary

I started in IT support and infrastructure in Pará, in northern Brazil. I went from analyst to IT supervisor, did a stint in a tier 1 SOC, and only then moved fully into security. These days I work only with Microsoft's security stack.

That infrastructure background pays off every day. When an alert fires, I know how the machine, the network and the identity behind it actually work.

I also teach as an MCT and run workshops for Microsoft's MCI program (Threat Protection and Cloud Security).

Experience

SGA TI em Nuvem

Jan 2026 – present

Cybersecurity Specialist (contractor)

- I run Defender XDR, Defender for Cloud, Sentinel, Purview and Entra ID for several clients at once through Azure Lighthouse. They're in healthcare, finance, manufacturing and government.
- I assess each client's security maturity and design the architecture around Zero Trust, using NIST, MITRE ATT&CK and the Cloud Adoption Framework as the yardstick.
- I investigate incidents and hunt threats in KQL. Anything that repeats becomes a PowerShell script or a Logic Apps playbook.
- Rolled out Sentinel for a financial holding with several companies under it: connectors from different sources, detection rules, workbooks and playbooks.
- I lead Microsoft MCI workshops (Threat Protection and Cloud Security), including environments spread across Azure, AWS and Google Cloud, and write the technical and executive documentation for each delivery.

Avanade

Jul 2022 – May 2026

Cloud and Infrastructure Security Analyst (full-time)

- Managed more than 70,000 devices (Windows, Linux, Android and iOS) in Intune and Configuration Manager: apps, compliance, configuration and updates.
- Deployed and ran Defender for Endpoint, Defender for Office 365, Defender for Cloud, Sentinel, Entra ID and Defender Vulnerability Management, covering incident investigation, hardening and vulnerability management.
- Reviewed 69 Sentinel analytics rules ahead of Microsoft's account entity naming change (July 2026). 17 were fine, 52 needed KQL fixes.
- At a large energy company, deployed Defender for Endpoint on Linux and migrated SCEP certificates through Intune to meet KDC Strong authentication.

Microsoft certifications

Security and identity

Cybersecurity Architect Expert
SC-100, until Oct 2027

Security Operations Analyst Associate
SC-200, until Apr 2027

Identity and Access Administrator Associate
SC-300, until Jan 2027

Azure Security Engineer Associate
AZ-500, until Sep 2027

Security, Compliance, and Identity Fundamentals
SC-900, no expiry

Information Protection and Compliance Administrator Associate
SC-400, expired Mar 2026

Microsoft 365 Security Administrator Associate
MS-500, expired Nov 2024

Azure

Azure Solutions Architect Expert
AZ-305, until Sep 2027

Azure Administrator Associate
AZ-104, until Oct 2027

Azure Network Engineer Associate
AZ-700, until Aug 2027

Windows Server Administrator Associate
AZ-800 and AZ-801, until Jul 2027

Azure Fundamentals
AZ-900, no expiry

Microsoft 365 and endpoint

Microsoft 365 Administrator Expert
MS-100 and MS-101 (now MS-102), until Aug 2027

Endpoint Administrator Associate
MD-100 and MD-101 (now MD-102), until Feb 2027

Microsoft 365 Fundamentals
MS-900, no expiry

Click a name to open the credential on Microsoft Learn. Full list:
learn.microsoft.com/users/mikionakamaru

- Led MCI Threat Protection workshops for banks and manufacturers, and kept Microsoft 365 and Azure running (Exchange Online, SharePoint, Teams, Azure Monitor, Log Analytics, Azure Arc, AD and VMware), with PowerShell automation.

WorkDB Data Business
Jun 2020 – Jul 2022

Information Security Analyst (Nov 2021 to Jul 2022)
IT Support Analyst (Jun 2020 to Nov 2021)

- Joined a consultancy serving clients across industries: Windows and Linux, Microsoft 365, Azure, AD, firewalls, backups, SQL Server, MySQL and Oracle. I also monitored in a tier 1 SOC with Zabbix, Grafana and Elastic.
- I saw room for the company to grow in Microsoft. Passed MS-900 and AZ-900, led the internal Intune rollout and became the in-house go-to person for the platform.
- Promoted into security, I ran projects on Intune, SCCM and Entra ID (AD Connect, ADFS, MIM), vulnerability management, log analysis, incident response and on-prem to Azure migrations.

Secretaria de Estado de Educação do Pará (SEDUC/PA)
Feb 2018 – Feb 2020

IT Support Analyst

- Hired through a public selection process to support a large pool of users and equipment.
- Mostly Linux: workstation administration, OS and software installs, printers, networking and maintenance. Windows when needed.

SENAR Pará
Jan 2014 – Jan 2017

IT Supervisor (Aug 2014 to Jan 2017)
IT Support Analyst (Jan 2014 to Aug 2014)

- Started out keeping the infrastructure running: Windows and Linux servers, wired and wireless networks, firewall, MikroTik, switches, databases, file and print servers and digital certificates.
- Promoted to supervisor in under a year. I led the support team, set priorities, tracked metrics and fixed processes.
- I did technical contract reviews, supported procurement, assessed vendors and put together modernization proposals. That's when I started my postgraduate degree in IT management.

Casa do Sorveteiro
Nov 2012 – Jan 2014

Systems Analyst

- Ran and supported the WinThor ERP behind the company's daily operations.
- Looked after the infrastructure: Active Directory, backups, maintenance and networking. I also pulled cabling and installed the Wi-Fi access points.

Featured projects

Microsoft Sentinel rollout for a multi-company holding
Financial services, May to Jun 2026 · SGA TI em Nuvem

MCI Cloud Security workshops in multicloud environments
4 clients across industries, 2026 · SGA TI em Nuvem

Other credentials

Microsoft Certified Trainer (MCT)
since Dec 2021

ITIL 4 Foundation

Stack

Detection and response: Microsoft Sentinel (SIEM/SOAR), Defender XDR, Defender for Endpoint, Defender for Office 365, Defender for Identity, Defender Vulnerability Management, Security Exposure Management, Threat hunting (KQL)

Cloud and data: Defender for Cloud (CSPM/CWPP), Microsoft Purview (DLP, Information Protection), Azure, Azure Arc, Azure Lighthouse, Log Analytics

Identity and endpoint: Microsoft Entra ID, Entra ID Protection, Conditional Access, Microsoft Intune, Configuration Manager (SCCM/MECM), Jamf Pro

Automation: KQL, PowerShell, Logic Apps

Frameworks: Zero Trust, MITRE ATT&CK, NIST CSF

Talks

Técnico, Especialista ou Gestor? A carreira em Y na cibersegurança
MVP Conf Brasil 2026, Sep 26

Seu RAG tem mais acesso que o CISO
TDC São Carlos 2026 (São Carlos Experience), Aug 27

Education

Postgraduate specialization in IT Management
Faculdade Ideal (Faci Wyden), Belém, completed Jan 2018

Postgraduate specialization in Computing in Education
Universidade da Amazônia (Unama), Belém, 2010 to 2012

Associate degree in Computer Networks
Faculdade Ideal (Faci), Belém, completed Feb 2010

Languages

Portuguese, native
English, professional (reading and writing)

Compliance review of 69 Sentinel analytics rules

Education, Dec 2025 · Avanade

Defender for Endpoint on critical Linux infrastructure

Energy, Sep to Nov 2023 · Avanade

All projects at **mikionakamaru.github.io/projetos/en/**